

Lectures: Tues & Thurs 2:00-3:15 AM
109 Bausch & Lomb

All lectures are recorded and posted on Blackboard via Panopto

Instructor: Alexis Stein, PhD

Office: Hutchison Hall 460

alexis.stein@rochester.edu

Course Modality: This course meets in person 2x week for lecture. In addition to lecture, you will have a mandatory recitation. This section also provides additional support through a required weekly mentoring section that focuses more on skills that help you succeed as a STEM major overall. All intro bio students complete 5 hands-on labs, in addition to other required course work.

Course Description: First semester in a course sequence for all biology majors. The course will introduce biochemistry, cell biology, molecular biology, and animal physiology. Emphasis will be placed on quantitative learning and data analysis; weekly workshops will emphasize the construction and interpretation of graphs.

Course Objectives: By the end of this course, students should be able to:

- 1) Correctly identify the major components of a plant and animal cell and the stages of cell division.
- 2) Understand the central dogma and the underlying biological mechanisms.
- 3) Describe how DNA is stored, replicated, and mutated.
- 4) Explain how the circulatory, nervous system, and urinary system of a mammal function.

Learning Outcomes:

- 1) Interpret scientific figures and graphs.
- 2) Summarize the primary conclusions of an experiment.
- 3) Solve mathematical problems using scientific notation.

Office Hours: Tuesday 10-11am; Wednesday 1-2pm; Thursday 12-1pm and by appointment in Hutch Hall 460. Office hours are an opportunity for you to ask questions and seek clarification on course material. Come prepared with specific questions or topics you would like to discuss. *You are also welcome to come and listen to other students' questions.*

If you have questions related to your grade in the course or of a personal nature, please email me for a private appointment rather than bringing these sensitive topics to office hours where other students will be present.

If you need to attend via Zoom, please email me and let me know, that way I will make sure to open the zoom link below.

Zoom Link: <https://rochester.zoom.us/j/92879872348>

Course Prerequisites: There are no prerequisites for this course.

Credit Hours: 4 -This course follows the College credit hour policy for four-credit courses. This course meets two times weekly for three academic hours per week. The course also includes a recitation for one academic hour per week.

Recitations: You are **required** to attend your assigned recitation section. Part of these sessions will be devoted to solving problems and reviewing material, which will be **very helpful** in preparing for exams.

Teaching Assistants:Sophia Nolan – snolan6@u.rochester.eduIsaac Morse – imorse@u.rochester.eduSean Ganet – sgenet@u.rochester.eduKristen Kam – kkam2@u.rochester.eduStervie Guzman – sguzman5@u.rochester.eduLila Huckelbridge – lhuckelb@u.rochester.edu**Recitation Schedule:**

Section	Meeting Day Patterns	Meeting Time Pattern	Room	TA
BIOL 110L-22 - Principles of Biology 	Wednesday	11:50 AM - 1:50 PM	Hylan Building Room 206	Isaac M
BIOL 110L-17 - Principles of Biology 	Wednesday	12:30 PM - 2:30 PM	Meliora Room 284	Lila H
BIOL 110L-06 - Principles of Biology 	Wednesday	4:50 PM - 6:50 PM	Hylan Room 301	Sean G
BIOL 110L-13 - Principles of Biology 	Thursday	4:50 PM - 6:50 PM	Todd Union Room 202	Isaac M
BIOL 110L-26 - Principles of Biology 	Thursday	4:50 PM - 6:50 PM	Morey Room 504	Stervie G
BIOL 110L-82 - Principles of Biology 	Friday	11:50 AM - 1:50 PM	Hylan Building Room 305	Sophia N
BIOL 110L-85 - Principles of Biology 	Friday	2:00 PM - 4:00 PM	Lattimore Room 413	Kristen K

Suggested Reading: Assigned chapters from *Principles of Life, 3rd Edition*, Hillis et al. (Macmillan). All content that will be tested will be presented in class. The textbook is optional to purchase but some students like to have it as a resource.

Instructor Response and Feedback

Students should expect to receive responses to emails within *48 hours*. On weekends and holidays the response may be slower. Additionally, feedback on your exam grades will be within 1 week after the exam. If an exam falls near a holiday this may extend this window.

Grades:

Your success in this course depends on your curiosity, active participation, and dedication. To thrive, engage with the material **regularly**, ask questions, collaborate with classmates, and seek help when needed. Remember, biology is a vast and fascinating field—your efforts will help you unlock an understanding of the living world. The mentors, TA's and I are here to support your learning.

Grades will be based on recitation participation, mentoring group participation, four exams, and your lab.

Exam 1: 15%
Exam 2: 20%
Exam 3: 20%
Exam 4: 25%
Recitation: 5%
Mentoring: 5%
Lab: 10%

Total: 100%

Grade	Percents
A+, A	93 - 100
A-	90 - 92
B+	87 - 89
B	83 - 86
B-	80 - 82
C+	77 - 79
C	73 - 76
C-	70 - 72
D+	67 - 69
D	63 - 66
D-	60 - 62
F	Below 60

Letter grades will be assigned using the following scale. Depending on the overall performance of the entire class, a curve may be applied. Grade updates will be provided after each exam.

Examinations: Three exams will be given during class time (9/18, 10/16, and 11/13) from 2:00-3:15 PM in our normal lecture location. A comprehensive three-hour final will be given during finals week, December 13 @ 12:30pm) The examinations will cover information and concepts discussed in the lectures and recitations. Questions are primarily in the form of short answers and require both recall and application of material taught.

All four exams are required. Students with an **excused** absence (illness) from one of the three midterm exams will be given a make-up exam in essay format. **You must contact the UPBM office by 4:30 pm on the day of the exam to schedule a makeup exam.** (BioDeptUgOffice@ur.rochester.edu).

The biology office will offer **ONE** make up exam time. You must make that exam or receive a zero on the exam. **No student will take more than one makeup exam during the semester.** The final exam is required of all students. If you cannot attend the final you will have to request to take the course as an Incomplete and make up the final during a later semester.

Accommodations: The University of Rochester respects and welcomes students of all backgrounds and abilities. In the event you encounter and barrier(s) to full participation in this course due to the impact of a disability please contact the Office of Disability Resources. The access coordinators can meet with you to discuss the barriers you are experiencing and explain the eligibility process for establishing accommodations. You can reach the Office of Disability Resources at: disability@rochester.edu; 585-276-5075; Taylor Hall. You can also always schedule a meeting with me to discuss any concerns.

Mental Health: As a student you may experience a range of issues that can cause barriers to learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, alcohol/drug problems, feeling down, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may lead to diminished academic performance or reduce a student's ability to participate in daily activities. The University of Rochester is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of support, services are available. You can learn more about the broad range of confidential mental health services available on campus via the CARE Network: [https:// www.rochester.edu/care/students.html](https://www.rochester.edu/care/students.html). If you feel that health issues, of any sort, are a barrier to your academic progress, please communicate your concerns with Dr. Stein. We strive to accommodate the needs of all students, regardless of challenges to physical or mental health.

Academic Honesty: All assignments and activities associated with this course must be performed in accordance with the University of Rochester's Academic Honesty Policy. All work for this course including exams and homework assignments must represent each student's *individual* effort. Turning in homework assignments that are identical or nearly so to the solutions manual, solutions found online, or another student's work will be considered an infringement on the honesty policy of this course. Plagiarism in any form on any assignment including the written take home paper will be taken seriously and punished following University guidelines. More information is available at: www.rochester.edu/college/honesty/.

Optional Research Study Enrollment:

Students in BIOL 110L-02, who are 18 years of age or older, are eligible to participate in a research study investigating potential links between mentoring sessions, academic performance in BIOL 110L-02, and the development and retention of skills and knowledge necessary for continued academic success in biology and other science courses. Participation in the study is optional, voluntary, confidential and will not affect your grade in the course. As a participant in the study, you **will** be asked to allow the study investigators access your exam grades, final course grade, and demographic information, and you **will not** be asked to complete any assignments or activities in addition to those required for successful completion of the course (e.g. complete a short skills inventory, attend mentoring sessions, complete problem sets, exams and exam wrappers). More information about the study is available on Blackboard and will be presented in class. Please contact Alice Hunt (alice.hunt@rochester.edu) with questions about the study.

Below is a list of important dates! This schedule is subject to change at the instructor's discretion.

August:

Tuesday 8/26: Classes Start

September:

Recitations start the week of 9/2

Monday 9/22: Add/drop deadline

Thursday 9/18: EXAM 1

October:

Monday-Tuesday 10/13-10/14: FALL BREAK (No Recitations this week)

Thursday 10/16: EXAM 2

November:

Monday 11/10: Last day to take a W

Thursday 11/13: EXAM 3

Wed – Friday 11/26-11/28: THANKSGIVING BREAK

December:

Monday 12/1: Last day S/F

Thursday 12/4: Last day of Lecture

Saturday 12/13: 12:30pm FINAL EXAM